

Self-Care Assessment

Adapted from Saakvitne, Pearlman, & Staff of TSI/CAAP (1996). *Transforming the pain: A workbook on vicarious traumatization*. Norton.

The following worksheet for assessing self-care is not exhaustive, merely suggestive. Feel free to add areas of self-care that are relevant for you and rate yourself on how often and how well you are taking care of yourself these days.

When you are finished, look for patterns in your responses. Are you more active in some areas of self-care but ignore others? Are there items on the list that make you think, "I would never do that"? Listen to your inner responses, your internal dialogue about self-care and making yourself a priority. Take particular note of anything you would like to include more in your life.

Rate the following areas according to how well you think you are doing:

- 3 = I do this well (e.g., frequently)
- 2 = I do this OK (e.g., occasionally)
- 1 = I barely or rarely do this
- 0 = I never do this
- ? = This never occurred to me

Physical Self-Care

- 3 Eat regularly (e.g. breakfast, lunch, and dinner)
- 2 Eat healthily
- 1 Exercise
- 1 Get regular medical care for prevention
- 2 Get medical care when needed
- 1 Take time off when sick
- 0 Get massages
- 0 Dance, swim, walk, run, play sports, sing, or do some other fun physical activity
- 2 Take time to be sexual - with myself, with a partner
- 0 Get enough sleep
- 3 Wear clothes I like
- 1 Take vacations
- Other:

Psychological Self-Care

- 1 Take day trips or mini-vacations
- 0 Make time away from telephones, email, and the Internet
- 0 Make time for self-reflection
- 2 Notice my inner experience - listen to my thoughts, beliefs, attitudes, feelings
- 1 Have my own personal psychotherapy
- 1 Write in a journal
- 0 Read literature that is unrelated to work
- 1 Do something at which I am not expert or in charge
- 0 Attend to minimizing stress in my life
- 1 Engage my intelligence in a new area, e.g., go to an art show, sports event, theatre
- 3 Be curious

- 1___ Say no to extra responsibilities sometimes
___ Other:

Emotional Self-Care

- 2___ Spend time with others whose company I enjoy
3___ Stay in contact with important people in my life
0___ Give myself affirmations, praise myself
1___ Love myself
2___ Re-read favorite books, re-view favorite movies
1___ Identify comforting activities, objects, people, places and seek them out
3___ Allow myself to cry
3___ Find things that make me laugh
3___ Express my outrage in social action, letters, donations, marches, protests
___ Other:

Spiritual Self-Care

- 2___ Make time for reflection
1___ Spend time in nature
0___ Find a spiritual connection or community
2___ Be open to inspiration
2___ Cherish my optimism and hope
2___ Be aware of non-material aspects of life
3___ Try at times not to be in charge or the expert
3___ Be open to not knowing
3___ Identify what is meaningful to me and notice its place in my life
1___ Meditate
0___ Pray
3___ Sing
3___ Have experiences of awe
3___ Contribute to causes in which I believe
3___ Read inspirational literature or listen to inspirational talks, music
___ Other:

Relationship Self-Care

- 2___ Schedule regular dates with my partner or spouse
1___ Schedule regular activities with my children
2___ Make time to see friends
3___ Call, check on, or see my relatives
3___ Spend time with my companion animals
1___ Stay in contact with faraway friends
0___ Make time to reply to personal emails and letters; send holiday cards
1___ Allow others to do things for me
3___ Enlarge my social circle
1___ Ask for help when I need it
2___ Share a fear, hope, or secret with someone I trust
___ Other:

Workplace or Professional Self-Care

- 2 Take a break during the workday (e.g., lunch)
- 2 Take time to chat with co-workers
- 3 Make quiet time to complete tasks
- 1 Identify projects or tasks that are exciting and rewarding
- 1 Set limits with clients and colleagues
- 2 Balance my caseload so that no one day or part of a day is "too much"
- 2 Arrange work space so it is comfortable and comforting
- 2 Get regular supervision or consultation
- 2 Negotiate for my needs (benefits, pay raise)
- 2 Have a peer support group
- (If relevant) Develop a non-trauma area of professional interest

Overall Balance

- 2 Strive for balance within my work-life and work day
- 2 Strive for balance among work, family, relationships, play, and rest

Other Areas of Self-Care that are Relevant to You

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http://www.ballarat.edu.au/aasp/student/sds/self_care_assess.shtml and adapted by Lisa D. Butler, Ph.D.)